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Waterfront Buyer Due Diligence Checklist

Eastern Fort Lauderdale waterfront residences

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A working checklist for serious buyers of Fort Lauderdale waterfront residences. The list is organized by the diligence sequence Mia coordinates privately on her own engagements — survey first, water and dock data next, insurance underwriting before the offer. Each item is a question to bring to a licensed specialist, not a substitute for one.

Parcel basics

- ☐ Confirm folio number on the Broward County Property Appraiser record.
- ☐ Pull the legal description and confirm it matches the current survey on file.
- ☐ Cross-reference the address with the City of Fort Lauderdale property records.
- ☐ Note the parcel's zoning designation and any historic-district overlays.

Survey and legal description

- ☐ Order or request the most recent boundary survey from the seller's file.
- ☐ Confirm lot frontage on the canal, lot depth, and any setbacks of record.
- ☐ Identify any easements (drainage, utility, dockage, shared seawall).
- ☐ Flag any encroachments visible on the survey for legal review.

Dockage capacity

- ☐ Verify dock length, beam clearance, and fendering against the seller's dock permits.
- ☐ Confirm pile count and condition; request the most recent dock inspection if available.
- ☐ Note lift capacity, lift age, and any service history of the lift mechanism.
- ☐ Photograph the dock at low tide to confirm usable depth at the slip.

Seawall, cap, and tiebacks

- ☐ Request the seawall inspection report (cap condition, tieback integrity, prior remediation).
- ☐ Note the seawall's installation year and any documented repairs.
- ☐ Confirm whether any seawall reserve fund or HOA reserve covers shared sections.
- ☐ Walk the seawall at low tide with the marine contractor if the inspection is older than 5 years.

Canal, turning basin, bridge clearance

- ☐ Measure canal width at the residence and at the nearest turning basin.
- ☐ Confirm bridge clearances along the route to Port Everglades (or Hillsboro Inlet for residences farther north).
- ☐ Identify each drawbridge on the route and its current operating schedule.
- ☐ Confirm route-to-inlet count: number of fixed bridges (zero is the deepwater premium) and number of opening bridges.

Flood zone, elevation, prior claims

- ☐ Pull the FEMA flood zone designation for the parcel.
- ☐ Request the elevation certificate; confirm the lowest finished floor elevation and reference datum.
- ☐ Request prior-claim history (a CLUE report from the seller or carrier where available).
- ☐ Compare flood-zone designation against any recent floodplain map revisions.

Insurance underwriting sequence

- ☐ Engage a Florida-licensed insurance broker before the offer goes in, not after.
- ☐ Request quotes against the seller's recent 4-point inspection and wind-mitigation report.
- ☐ Confirm whether the parcel qualifies for private windstorm coverage or routes to Citizens.
- ☐ Note any underwriting conditions that would require remediation before binding.

Systems inspection

- ☐ Order the 4-point inspection: roof, electrical, plumbing, HVAC.
- ☐ Order a wind-mitigation inspection to capture credits.

- ☐ Walk the property with a licensed home inspector experienced in waterfront residences.
- ☐ For older renovations, request a permit-history pull to confirm closed permits.

Renovation and permit history

- ☐ Pull the City of Fort Lauderdale building-permit history (LauderBuild).
- ☐ Confirm every renovation has a closed permit; note any open or expired permits.
- ☐ For dock or seawall work in the past 10 years, confirm the marine-contractor permit closed.
- ☐ Note any HOA architectural-review records for cosmetic or structural changes.

Specialist roster

Mia coordinates the introductions; the specialists' findings — not Mia's summaries — are the ground truth.

- ☐ Licensed home inspector with waterfront-residence experience.
- ☐ Florida-licensed marine contractor (dock, seawall, lift).
- ☐ Land surveyor for boundary, elevation, and as-built confirmations.
- ☐ Florida-licensed insurance broker familiar with coastal underwriting.
- ☐ Mortgage advisor (when financing), with coastal-Florida portfolio experience.
- ☐ Title insurance / closing attorney with Broward County jurisdiction.

Next step

The diligence above is a starting list. Mia coordinates the engagement of licensed specialists — inspectors, surveyors, marine contractors, insurance brokers, lenders, title agents — whose findings are the ground truth for any specific residence.

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Source ledger

- Broward County Property Appraiser — <https://web.bcpa.net/>
- City of Fort Lauderdale property records — <https://www.fortlauderdale.gov/>
- City of Fort Lauderdale LauderBuild permit portal
- FEMA Flood Map Service Center — <https://msc.fema.gov/>
- Florida OIR — windstorm/4-point/wind-mitigation guidance
- MIA-SITE Cycle 18 source ledger —
docs/CYCLE_18_FORT_LAUDERDALE_POMPAÑO_RESEARCH_LEDGER.md

Important: not professional advice

Not legal, insurance, inspection, marine survey, engineering, tax, or lending advice. The information in this document is a working checklist drawn from Mia Sanabria's coordination experience with Eastern Fort Lauderdale waterfront residences. Mia coordinates the engagement of licensed specialists — inspectors, surveyors, marine contractors, insurance brokers, lenders, title agents — whose findings, not this document, are the ground truth for any specific residence.

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Luxury and waterfront real estate across Eastern Fort Lauderdale, Boca Raton, and Delray Beach. Real estate guidance for luxury Eastern Fort Lauderdale, Eastern Boca Raton, and Eastern Delray Beach buyers and sellers, delivered with discretion and rigor.



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BROKERAGE

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